



JEMAL COUNTESS/GETTY IMAGES FOR LEGAL DEFENSE FUND

Demonstrators (above and below) gathered in front of the Supreme Court on Wednesday. The court could rule quickly.

Taking race out of voting maps

High court appears ready to weaken key part of law, possibly bringing major change

By Abbie VanSickle
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court appeared poised on Wednesday to weaken a key provision of a landmark civil rights law by sharply limiting the ability of lawmakers to use race as a factor in drawing voting maps, which could lead to widespread redistricting efforts.

If the justices determine that lawmakers cannot consider race when drawing districts, the consequences for the country's political balance could be sweeping. The decision could end the practice, endorsed by the court for decades, of crafting congressional districts with the purpose



CLIFF OWEN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

of helping minority voters elect the candidates of their choice.

Republican state legislatures could use the ruling to eliminate around a dozen Democratic-held House districts across the South, according to a New York Times analysis.

The court typically issues major rulings by late June or early July, but could rule more quickly in the voting case. It is not clear if states could act in time for the 2026 midterm elections, should the justices agree to upend the Voting Rights Act of 1965.

The case examines whether Louisiana lawmakers violated the Constitution when they ad-

VOTING, Page A6

Moulton says time is now to take on Markey

As he launches his bid, he points to senator's age

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Democratic Representative Seth Moulton of Salem on Wednesday officially launched his challenge to longtime incumbent Senator Ed Markey in the 2026 primary, arguing “it’s time for a new generation of leadership for Democrats and for America.”

In an exclusive interview with the Globe, Moulton, the 46-year old Iraq War veteran and six-term congressman, said he’s running for Senate because “leaders in our party continue to follow the same old playbook that has allowed [President] Trump to tear apart our country and hurt so many people in Massachusetts and across America.”

His reason for challenging Markey isn’t ideological: in fact, Moulton said he agrees with Markey on “the vast majority of issues.”

Instead, he pointed to Markey’s age and seniority — he is turning 80 next July and has served in Congress since 1976 — as core concerns behind his campaign. Moulton believes Democrats risk losing voters’ trust, and elections, if they continue to back candidates who are seen as too old.

“Is he too old?” Moulton said. “Look, every political consultant will tell me not to say this, but

MOULTON, Page A7

Local police in the middle as ICE keeps heat on cities

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Last year, Elionidas Najera-Perez was arrested by Norwood police three times for allegedly operating under the influence and without a license. And each time, federal immigration authorities had an interest in him: he had unlawfully reentered the country after being deported a decade ago.

But US Immigration and Customs Enforcement could not expect Norwood police to simply hand Najera-Perez over so it could deport him again, because of a state law that limits local law enforcement cooperation on immigration matters, which are largely civil violations under federal rules.

Federal authorities could have criminally charged Najera-Perez for returning but had yet to do so. And since there was no such violation to detain him, Norwood police would release him on bail on the OUI charge after entering his fingerprints into a nationwide law enforcement database.

That left immigration agents to track him down on their own. He was taken into custody in March and subsequently deported.

The situation underscores how law enforcement

ICE, Page A7

Pot dispensary too close for some people’s comfort

Concerns about shop opening near day-care center

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Just a few dozen steps across Kirkland Street and the Somerville line separate the Tree House Academy day care from a new ice cream shop, where scratch-made scoops of Brown Sugar Cookie Dough are sold.

And soon, parents and toddlers leaving the child-care center are set to see a business offering an altogether different vice right next door: a pot shop.

Not everyone is thrilled by this soon-to-arrive neighbor. Nine years after voters made it legal to sell recreational marijuana, the siting of a dispensary continues to generate tensions in the neighborhoods where they open. Even in Cambridge, Somerville, and other cities with a let-live attitude on cannabis, some would still prefer the

stores not encroach on their corners of the city — especially when those corners are full of kids.

Tree House Academy executive director Mara Coelho said she fears that the dispensary could lead to people smoking near little ones, or that products might be left behind where they can find them, and “directly impact the children, families, and staff who walk through the area daily.”

Steven DeMarco, the dispensary owner who has leased the space on Kirkland Street for the past year-and-a-half as he works to get it open, said he takes the concerns seriously, and that they are “entirely justified for the kids they look after.”

He has workable solutions to all of them, he said, and can point to plenty of other dispensa-

MARIJUANA, Page A10



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Taking your leaves

Thursday: Breezy, cool.
High 52-57. Low 44-49.

Friday: Seasonable.
High 58-63. Low 42-47.

High tide: 8:07 a.m., 8:24 p.m.
Sunrise: 6:58 Sunset: 6:00

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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Brown University rejected the Trump administration's demand that the school sign a “compact” in exchange for preferential treatment. B1.

Democratic leaders questioned President Trump's threat to take away World Cup games from the state. B1.



Joan Bennett Kennedy was laid to rest after a funeral attended by many members of the famous family. **B1.**

Hamas's military wing said it had handed over all of the remains of Israeli hostages that it had been able to recover. **A3.**

Teen’s arrest shows scope of federal operation

By Sean Cotter, Marcela Rodrigues, and Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Within just a few hours last Thursday, a 13-year-old immigrant from Everett was arrested on suspicion he had threatened another student, brought to the police station, fingerprinted, and then as his mother waited outside, picked up by federal immigration officials.

By the next day, the boy, whose parents have a pending asylum case, would be whisked to a detention facility 500 miles away.

The remarkably swift passage of the juvenile into the Trump administration’s deportation system, purportedly without the explicit cooperation of local police, underscores the reach and efficiency of the infrastructure that Immigration and Customs Enforcement has managed to build even in deep-blue Massachusetts.

The case also demonstrates how federal agents can, in some cases, work around Massachusetts case law that prohibits police departments from detaining immigration targets unless there is a federal criminal warrant

EVERETT, Page A10



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

A City Council meeting in Everett was crowded Tuesday after a protest against the arrest and removal of a 13-year-old boy to a detention facility.

